Acer TimelineX refreshed
Acer has released two models of the new Aspire TimelineX laptop series in India - Aspire 5830T and 5830TG - starting from ₹32,999.

Women Prefer Games
A Doritos survey found that more female online gamers (FOGs) liked playing online games, than FOGs who liked shopping or having sex

Notebook graphics go crazy

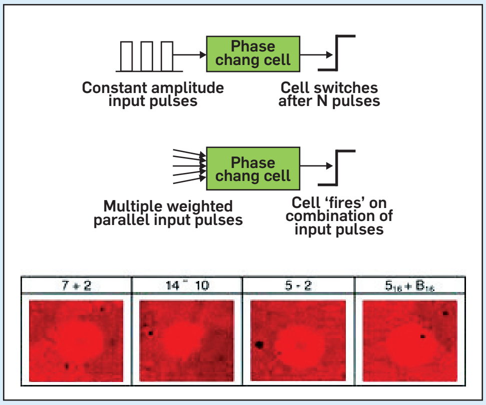
While AMD has been relatively quiet in the recent past about the growing prowess and adoption of its laptop graphics technologies, it has now decided to snatch some of the much publicise recent glory of Nvidia's GeForce GTX 580M GPU, by releasing the AMD Radeon HD 6990M as contender for the crown of the world's fastest mobile graphics card. Claiming 25% better performance than the previous top-end HD 6970M offering, the HD 6990M is based on the same Northern Islands family's Barts core as the 6970M, but with more stream processors, and faster clocks.

Yes Barts, and not the full-fledged Cayman architecture of the desktop HD 6990 GPU. Specifications of the HD 6990M GPU include a core clock speed of 715MHz, 2GB of GDDR5 RAM at 3.6GHz memory clock speed, a 256-bit bus with a bandwidth of 115.2GB/s, 32 ROPs, 56 texture units, and 1120 stream processors. The core clock of the card can be overclocked up to 740Mhz. The most noticeable difference between the GTX 580M and HD 6990M, apart from CUDA and PhysX, will have to be the lack of a switchable graphics solution like Nvidia Optimus for the AMD Radeon HD 6990M. This could have a serious impact on battery life, figures of which were notably omitted from the introductory announcement.

The AMD Radeon HD 6990M is already out in markets, starting with gaming laptops like the Alienware M18x, which offers it in single or CrossFire configurations. The M17x and M18x also come with the option of GeForce GTX 580M, Nvidia's "world's fastest notebook GPU". Based on the new GF114 core on the 40nm fabrication process, the GTX 580M has 32 render back ends, 8 tessellation engines, 384 stream processing units, 64 texture units, and a 256-bit memory controller. The core clock speed is 620MHz, while the stream processor clocks in at 1240MHz. Partners are recommended to clock the GDDR5 memory at 1.5GHz.

Brain-like processors created, with simultaneous data processing and storage

Folks over at the University of Exeter have demonstrated what they call the memflector – an optical equivalent of the memristor. Built using advanced semiconductor materials capable of phase-change, the team has constructed a processor that can compute and store data simultaneously. This is quite unlike today's computers,



each phase-change cell mimicking the "integrate and fire" mechanism of a neuron. The processor is also capable of reliably executing the four basic arithmetic functions.

Hopes are high for the new technology, and the team's next step is down the biological alley, aiming

which have separate components for memory and processing, but is supposedly very similar to what our brains, or biological computers do.

The team is calling their advancements a large step forward in computing, potentially leading to much faster, cheaper, and more power efficient computers. The work is also a big step toward achieving another milestone in the field – 'brain-like' computing. The memflector-based processor demonstrated synaptic-like functionality, with to develop better brain-like computers by making their still basic processor much more complex, with interconnected systems of phase change cells that can 'learn' simple tasks using both memory and computing, such as pattern and object recognition.

LulzSec ends 50-day Anti-Security campaign

LulzSec announced on Saturday that it would be ceasing activities, now that its "planned 50 day cruise" for the Lulz Boat is over. The "crew of six" hackers said in their sign off that they

hoped the AntiSec movement, or Operation Anti-Security, would continue without them, and that it had inspired others enough to spark a "revolution." Previous hacks have included everything from Sony Europe to the CIA's homepage.